

বাকিবন্ধু Founder's Kit

Everything to launch a collection-first ledger for Bangladeshi micro-merchants — **built solo, on zero budget**. Validate the pain, then build the smallest thing that solves it.

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 The **Merchant Tracker** (BakiBondhu_Phase0_Merchant_Tracker.xlsx) is a live spreadsheet and travels as a separate Excel file alongside this PDF.

The collection-first ledger that gets Bangladesh's shopkeepers **paid back**.

BakiBondhu is a **Bangla-first mobile app** that helps micro-merchants recover the credit (বাকি) they're owed — built solo, on zero budget, starting in Bangladesh and scaling to every market where informal credit still runs on paper.

THE PROBLEM

~8M Bangladeshi micro-businesses sell on বাকি, track it on paper, forget who owes what, and lose money every month. Recording isn't the pain — **getting paid back is**.

THE SOLUTION

A dead-simple app that makes **collection the main event**: running balances, aging, and one-tap polite Bangla SMS/WhatsApp reminders. Free to start, offline-first, deep in one trade.

WHY NOW

Cheap Android + bKash/Nagad normalised digital money. **1M+ merchants already use digital ledgers** — behaviour proven. India's Khatabook proved the model at scale.

COMPETITION & EDGE

TallyKhata (giant, but chasing payments & lending) and HishabPati (paid accounting suite) bury collection as a feature. **We own it** — winning on focus, simplicity & vertical depth.

BUSINESS MODEL

Free core; revenue from paid reminders, multi-shop & pro tools (~**৳200/merchant/mo**). Later: SME-lending referrals and supplier ordering.

STATUS — HONESTLY

Pre-launch, plan-ready. Strategy, competitor analysis, MVP spec, mockups & financial model done. Next step: 20–30 merchant interviews. No code or users yet.

THE NUMBERS — YEAR 1 (ILLUSTRATIVE RANGE)

Nobody pays	Pessimistic net	Base net	Optimistic net	Break-even	Business cash-at-risk
(৳15,500)	৳35,488	৳171,063	৳408,296	Month 7	~৳7,500

Tiny money risk in every case — the real investment is founder time. Everything hinges on one unproven fact: that merchants will pay.

THE TEAM & THE ASK

Technical solo founder — builds the product and funds personal runway via freelancing. **Seeking a co-founder who owns merchant sales & on-the-ground distribution**. Ground-floor equity, shared risk.

PHASE 0 • wk 1–3

Validate

20–30 merchant interviews

PHASE 1 • wk 4–10

Build MVP

5 screens, offline, Bangla

PHASE 2 • wk 11–16

50 users

prove daily use & retention

PHASE 3 • mo 5+

Monetise

paid tools → new markets

বাংলাদেশের দোকানদারদের বাকি টাকা ফেরত এনে দেওয়ার অ্যাপ।

বাকিবন্ধু বাংলায় তৈরি একটি মোবাইল অ্যাপ, যা ছোট ব্যবসায়ীদের তাদের প্রাপ্য বাকি টাকা আদায়ে সাহায্য করে — একা হাতে, শূন্য বাজেটে তৈরি; বাংলাদেশ থেকে শুরু করে বিশ্বের যেসব বাজারে এখনো কাগজের খাতায় বাকির হিসাব চলে, সেখানে ছড়িয়ে পড়ার লক্ষ্যে।

সমস্যা

বাংলাদেশে প্রায় ৮০ লক্ষ ছোট ব্যবসা বাকিতে বিক্রি করে, কাগজে হিসাব রাখে, কে কত বাকি তা ভুলে যায় এবং প্রতি মাসে পাওনা টাকা আদায় হয় না। হিসাব রাখা আসল সমস্যা নয় — টাকা ফেরত পাওয়াটাই সমস্যা।

সমাধান

একদম সহজ একটি অ্যাপ, যেখানে আদায়টাই মূল বিষয়: চলমান ব্যালেন্স, কত দিনের বাকি, আর এক চাপে ভদ্র বাংলা SMS/হোয়াটসঅ্যাপ রিমাইন্ডার। শুরু করতে ফ্রি, ইন্টারনেট ছাড়াই চলে, একটি নির্দিষ্ট ব্যবসায় গভীরভাবে।

এখনই কেন

সস্তা অ্যান্ড্রয়েড ফোন আর বিকাশ/নগদ ডিজিটাল টাকাকে স্বাভাবিক করেছে। ১০ লক্ষের বেশি ব্যবসায়ী এরই মধ্যে ডিজিটাল খাতা ব্যবহার করছেন — অভ্যাস প্রমাণিত। ভারতের Khatabook বড় পরিসরে এই মডেল প্রমাণ করেছে।

প্রতিযোগিতা ও আমাদের সুবিধা

TallyKhata (বড়, তবে পেমেন্ট ও ঋণের দিকে ঝুঁকছে) এবং HishabPati (পেইড অ্যাকাউন্টিং স্যুট) আদায়কে কেবল একটি ফিচার হিসেবে রাখে। আমরা এটিকেই মূল করি — মনোযোগ, সরলতা আর নির্দিষ্ট ব্যবসায় গভীরতা দিয়ে জিতি।

ব্যবসায়িক মডেল

মূল অ্যাপ ফ্রি; আয় আসবে পেইড রিমাইন্ডার, একাধিক দোকান ও প্রো টুল থেকে (প্রায় $\text{৳}200/\text{দোকান/মাস}$)। পরবর্তীতে: SME ঋণ রেফারেল ও সরবরাহকারীর কাছে অর্ডার।

অবস্থা — সংভাবে

লঞ্চের আগে, পরিকল্পনা প্রস্তুত। কৌশল, প্রতিযোগী বিশ্লেষণ, MVP স্পেস, মকআপ ও আর্থিক মডেল তৈরি। পরের ধাপ: ২০-৩০ জন ব্যবসায়ীর সাক্ষাৎকার। এখনো কোনো কোড বা ব্যবহারকারী নেই।

সংখ্যায় — প্রথম বছর (উদাহরণমূলক পরিসর)

কেউ টাকা দেয় না	খারাপ পরিস্থিতি (নিট)	মূল পরিস্থিতি (নিট)	ভালো পরিস্থিতি (নিট)	ব্রেক-ইভেন	ব্যবসায়িক নগদ ঝুঁকি
(৳15,500)	৳35,488	৳171,063	৳408,296	৭ম মাস	~৳7,500

প্রতিটি ক্ষেত্রেই টাকার ঝুঁকি সামান্য — আসল বিনিয়োগ প্রতিষ্ঠাতার সময়। সবকিছু নির্ভর করছে একটি অপ্রমাণিত বিষয়ের ওপর: ব্যবসায়ীরা আদৌ টাকা দেবেন কি না।

টিম ও যা প্রয়োজন

প্রযুক্তিতে দক্ষ একক প্রতিষ্ঠাতা — নিজেই প্রোডাক্ট তৈরি করেন এবং ফিল্ডওয়াশিং করে নিজের খরচ চালান। **খুঁজছি এমন একজন সহ-প্রতিষ্ঠাতা যিনি ব্যবসায়ীদের কাছে বিক্রি ও মাঠপর্যায়ের বিতরণের দায়িত্ব নেবেন।** শুরুর দিনের ইকুইটি, ভাগাভাগি করা ঝুঁকি।

ধাপ ০ · সপ্তাহ ১-৩

যাচাই

২০-৩০ জন ব্যবসায়ীর সাক্ষাৎকার

ধাপ ১ · সপ্তাহ ৪-১০

MVP তৈরি

৫টি স্ক্রিন, অফলাইন, বাংলা

ধাপ ২ · সপ্তাহ ১১-১৬

৫০ ব্যবহারকারী

প্রতিদিন ব্যবহার ও ধরে রাখা প্রমাণ

ধাপ ৩ · মাস ৫+

আয়

পেইড টুল → নতুন বাজার

Turn the paper খাতা into **taka** that comes back.

A ledger & due-collection app for micro-merchants — built solo, on **zero budget**, funded by part-time freelancing. Start where the pain and the phones already are, then follow the same problem across the developing world.

Working name: BakiBondhu (বাকি বন্ধু) · rename it once customers name it for you.

POSITIONING

BakiBondhu is the collection-first ledger — the app that gets a merchant's বাকি *paid back*, not just written down. Where TallyKhata chases payments & lending and HishabPati sells full accounting, we go deep on one job for one vertical: recovering what's owed.

THE MARKET

~8M

micro & small businesses in BD, most still on paper

YOUR CAPITAL

৳০

code + your time is the whole investment

THE WEDGE

বাকি

not recording — *collecting* the money owed to them

RUNWAY

USD

freelance part-time to cover living while you build

Why this, why now

Every neighborhood shop, pharmacy, and wholesaler sells on credit — বাকি. They track it in a paper notebook, forget who owes what, feel awkward asking, and quietly lose money every month. The recording isn't the real pain. **Getting paid back is.**

Meanwhile the rails already exist: cheap Android phones are everywhere, and bKash/Nagad made digital money normal. What's missing is a Bangla-first, offline-first tool that treats collection — reminders, aging, gentle nudges — as the main event, not an afterthought. That's your opening against the generic khata apps.

The path to first revenue

0

WK 1–3

Validate before you write real code

Goal: confirm the pain is collection, and pick the one vertical worth building for.

- Go in person to a market. Interview 20–30 merchants: *How do you track baki today? How much is stuck right now? What's the most painful part?*
- Lead hypothesis to test first: **wholesalers / distributors** — bigger credit cycles, more money at stake, more willing to pay than a corner shop.
- **Kill criteria:** if it isn't a top-3 problem in their own words, don't build it — pivot the vertical or the feature.

1

WK 4–10

Ship a painfully small MVP

Goal: one merchant can run their whole baki book on it — offline, in Bangla.

- Build only the loop below. Resist every extra feature until real users beg for it.
- One codebase, cheap-Android-first. Big buttons, Bangla labels, works with no signal.
- No handling of money yet — reminders only. That keeps you clear of financial regulation while you learn.

2

WK 11–16

Put it in 50 real hands

Goal: daily use and less stuck money — the only signals that matter.

- Hand-deliver to the merchants you interviewed. Sit and watch them use it; fix the friction you see every week.
- Track two numbers: **Do they open it daily?** and **Did their overdue baki drop?**
- Retention > growth. A tool used once is worthless; a daily habit is the whole moat.

3

MO 5+

Charge for what already works

Goal: first paying merchants, then a repeatable reason to expand.

- Core stays free. Charge for bulk SMS reminders (pass-through + margin), multi-shop, party-wise reports, pro collection tools.
- Later, bigger revenue: SME-lending referrals, supplier re-ordering, and — only when you understand the rules — bKash/Nagad-linked payment collection.

What the MVP is — and is not

► IN (THE WHOLE LOOP)

- ✓ Add a customer (party)
- ✓ Record a sale on credit — বাকি
- ✓ Record a payment received
- ✓ Running balance per party + total owed to you
- ✓ One-tap SMS / WhatsApp reminder in Bangla
- ✓ Works fully offline; syncs when online

► OUT (FOR NOW)

- ✗ In-app payments / wallet
- ✗ Full inventory & barcode
- ✗ Accounting, VAT, payroll
- ✗ Web dashboard
- ✗ Multi-language beyond Bangla
- ✗ Anything you can't explain in one sentence

Suggested stack (all free-tier): Flutter or React Native (one codebase) · local SQLite for offline · Supabase or Firebase free tier for sync/auth · an SMS gateway only when you monetize reminders. You already have the tech skills — the constraint is scope discipline, not tooling.

The money model

You don't need many payers. A wholesaler saving even a few thousand taka in recovered dues will happily pay a small monthly fee.

$$1,000 \times \text{₳}200/\text{mo} = \text{₳}2,00,000/\text{mo}$$

A realistic near-term target: ~1,000 paying merchants at ₳150–250/month. That funds you full-time — and proves the model is worth expanding.

Winning & what could go wrong

How you win vs. the khata apps

- Apps like TallyKhata & HishabPati exist — **don't fight them head-on.**
- Go **deep in one vertical's real workflow**: wholesaler credit cycles, party-wise aging, returns, partial payments.
- Be the **collection** app, not the recording app. That framing is your edge.
- Obsess over onboarding a non-technical shopkeeper in under 3 minutes.

Honest risks

- **Funded incumbents** — mitigate with niche depth they won't bother to match.
- **Retention is hard** — if it's not a daily habit, it dies. Design for the daily open.
- **SMS costs real money** — model it from day one; never give it away unbounded.
- **Don't touch handling funds** until you understand the regulations and partner APIs.

Then: the same problem, worldwide

Informal-credit ledgers are a global emerging-market problem. India's Khatabook reached millions of merchants on exactly this idea — proof the demand is real and huge. Prove retention in Bangladesh first, then localize language and payment rails market by market.

India — proven, massive

Pakistan

Nigeria

Indonesia

Egypt

+ LatAm

Because it's software, expanding costs almost nothing per new market — the hard part is the first market's retention, and you're solving that at home.

YOUR MOVE THIS WEEK

Don't open a code editor. Write down **30 merchants near you**, then go talk to **5** of them tomorrow. The plan lives or dies on what they tell you — everything after Phase 0 is just execution.

They built the ledger. You build the **collection**.

TallyKhata and HishabPati both let a merchant *record* baki. Neither is built to *get it paid back*. That gap — plus their size and complexity — is exactly where a focused newcomer wins. **Know them cold before you build against them.**

THE ONE INSIGHT

For both incumbents, the ledger is a **funnel**, not the product. TallyKhata's real business is payments & lending; HishabPati's is a paid accounting suite. Collection is a side-feature for both — so you can own it.

01 Side by side

	TallyKhata	HishabPati	BakiBondhu (you)
WHAT IT REALLY IS	Digital ledger evolving into a fintech super-app	Full mobile accounting & inventory suite	A collection-first tool for one vertical
CORE FOCUS	Record sales, stock, expenses + take payments + loans	Accounting, invoicing, inventory, reports	Getting বাকি paid back
BUSINESS MODEL	Free — monetizes via TallyPay wallet & credit	Paid subscription (Basic / Premium / Business)	Free core; paid reminders & pro tools later
BAKI & REMINDERS	A feature, secondary to the lending funnel	Dues tracked inside the accounting flow	The whole product: aging, nudges, one-tap
COMPLEXITY	Broad & growing — more super-app every year	Feature-rich, accounting-heavy	Deliberately tiny — 5 screens
PAYMENTS / MFS	Deep: QR, 34 banks, bKash/Rocket, own wallet	Invoicing + thermal-printer billing	None in v1 (on purpose)
SCALE	1M+ monthly active users — the giant	Smaller, SMB niche	Zero — starts with one market

figures from public sources — verify current details in Phase 0

02 Each one up close



TallyKhata

THE GIANT • BY PROGOTI SYSTEMS

STRENGTHS

- + 1M+ monthly active users — massive head start & trust
- + Free, works offline, in Bangla
- + Deep payments: one QR for 34 banks + bKash/Rocket, own central-bank-licensed wallet (TallyPay)
- + Moving into digital credit & loans for merchants

WEAKNESS (YOUR OPENING)

- △ Collection isn't the goal — lending & payments are; reminders stay a minor feature
- △ Getting broader & heavier as a super-app — not deep in any one trade's workflow
- △ Horizontal: serves "all small shops" generically, no vertical specialisation



HishabPati

THE ACCOUNTANT • BY MINDORBITAL

STRENGTHS

- + Full suite: sales, purchase, returns, dues, expenses, reports
- + Inventory + Bengali invoices + thermal-printer billing
- + Online/offline with automatic background sync
- + Some vertical content (e.g. salons/parlours)

WEAKNESS (YOUR OPENING)

- △ Complex & accounting-heavy — overkill for a shopkeeper who just wants to be paid
- △ Paid subscription is a barrier for a cautious micro-merchant
- △ Collection is buried inside accounting, not the headline job

03 How you win anyway

Don't fight them on their turf — change the game

- **Be the collection app, not the ledger app.** Everyone records; you make the money come back. That framing alone separates you.
- **Go absurdly deep in ONE vertical** (e.g. wholesalers): party-wise aging, partial payments, returns, credit limits — workflow a horizontal giant won't bother matching.
- **Win on simplicity.** Where they add features, you remove them. A shopkeeper should get value in 3 minutes with zero training.
- **Be non-intimidating & free to start** — the opposite of a paid accounting suite.
- **Make the reminder the hero** — the polite, one-tap Bangla nudge that both treat as an afterthought.

04 The honest reality check

READ THIS BEFORE YOU GET EXCITED

- **You cannot out-scale TallyKhata or out-feature HishabPati.** Don't try. Depth in one niche is your only viable edge.
- **Any incumbent could add better reminders.** So a feature is not a moat — your moat is vertical workflow depth, merchant relationships, and trust in one community.
- **TallyKhata's free + payments model is hard to compete with on price.** Charge for depth and outcomes (recovered dues), never for basic recording.
- **Distribution is their real advantage.** Plan how you'll reach merchants (one market, hand-to-hand, referrals) before worrying about features.

✓ Phase 0 to-do: in every interview, ask which app they tried and why they stopped. Their real reasons — not this page — decide your positioning.

SOURCES

tallykhata.com — official site

[The Business Standard — TallyKhata: digitising buying & selling on credit](#)

[Future Startup — TallyKhata's move into digital credit](#)

hishabpati.com — official site

[Google Play — হিসাবপাতি \(HishabPati\)](#)

Learn about their money — দোকান করবেন না।

A script for 20–30 merchant interviews. Read the Bangla aloud, keep the English for yourself. **You are not selling anything** — every answer is about how they run their shop today, not what they'd think of your app.

THE 4 RULES — BREAK THESE AND THE ANSWERS BECOME WORTHLESS

✓ **Ask about the past & present.** "How did you handle it last time?" Facts, not "would you use..." opinions.

✗ **Never pitch your idea.** The second you describe an app, they start being polite instead of honest.

✓ **Chase money & specifics.** Real taka amounts, real names, real last week. Vague = dig deeper.

✗ **Don't fill silences.** Ask, then stop talking. Let them think. The gold comes after the pause.

▶ Opening — set them at ease

Warm, short, and make clear you're not here to sell. Ask permission for their time.

আসসালামু আলাইকুম, ভাই। আমি রফিক। আমি ছোট ব্যবসায়ীদের বাকির হিসাব নিয়ে একটু জানার চেষ্টা করছি। আপনার ৫টা মিনিট সময় হবে? আমি কিছু বিক্রি করতে আসিনি — শুধু আপনার অভিজ্ঞতা শুনতে চাই।

"Assalamu alaikum, bhai. I'm Rafiq. I'm trying to understand how small shopkeepers manage their credit (baki). Do you have 5 minutes? I'm not selling anything — I just want to hear about your experience."

01 How they track baki today

Get them describing their **actual current system** — and if you can, get them to show you the notebook.

আপনি এখন বাকির হিসাব কীভাবে রাখেন? একটু দেখাবেন?

How do you keep track of baki right now? Can you show me?

LISTEN FOR Paper khata? Memory? Phone notes? An app? How messy is it?

দিনে বা সপ্তাহে কতজন কাস্টমার বাকিতে জিনিস নেয়?

How many customers buy on credit in a day or a week?

LISTEN FOR Volume — is baki a big part of the business or a side thing?

কোন কাস্টমার কত টাকা বাকি — এটা মনে রাখেন কীভাবে?

How do you remember which customer owes how much?

LISTEN FOR The moment memory or paper fails them.

02 The money at stake

This is the heart of it. Push gently for **real numbers** — the size of the problem is the size of your opportunity.

এই মুহুর্তে মোটামুটি কত টাকা বাকি পড়ে আছে বাজারে, আন্দাজে?

Roughly how much money is out there as unpaid baki right now?

LISTEN FOR An actual taka figure. Big number = big pain.

এর মধ্যে মাসে কত টাকার মতো আর ফেরত আসে না — একদম মার যায়?

Of that, how much never comes back each month — money you simply lose?

LISTEN FOR Their monthly loss. This is the number your app would save.

শেষ কবে বড় অঙ্কের টাকা মার গিয়েছিল? কী হয়েছিল, একটু বলবেন?

When did you last lose a big amount? Tell me what happened.

LISTEN FOR A real story — the emotion tells you how much this hurts.

03 The pain & what they already do

Find out what they've **already tried**. If they've built workarounds or paid for something, the pain is real.

বাকি নিয়ে সবচেয়ে বড় ঝামেলা বা মাথাব্যথা কোনটা?

What's the single most annoying part of dealing with baki?

LISTEN FOR Their words for the problem — use these later in your app.

টাকা তুলতে এখন কী করেন? ফোন দেন, নিজে যান, নাকি মনে করিয়ে দেন?

To collect the money, what do you do now — call, visit, remind them?

LISTEN FOR The collection ritual. This is exactly the job you'd automate.

কাউকে বাকি টাকার কথা মনে করিয়ে দিতে কেমন লাগে?

How does it feel to remind someone about the money they owe?

LISTEN FOR Awkwardness — a neutral SMS reminder solves an emotional pain, not just an admin one.

হিসাবের জন্য মোবাইলে কোনো অ্যাপ ব্যবহার করেছেন কখনো? (যেমন
টালিখাতা / হিসাবপাতি) কেমন লাগলো, এখনো চালান?

Have you ever used a phone app for this (e.g. TallyKhata / HishabPati)? How was it — still using it?

LISTEN FOR Why they quit. That gap is your opening against the incumbents.

04 Willingness to pay — asked indirectly

Never ask "would you pay for an app?" — everyone says yes to be nice. Instead ask about money they've **already spent**.

হিসাব রাখা বা টাকা তোলার জন্য কখনো কোনো কিছু পেছনে টাকা খরচ করেছেন? (খাতা, লোক, SMS?)

Have you ever spent money on tracking or collecting — a ledger, a person, SMS?

LISTEN FOR Any existing spend proves a budget exists for this problem.

কাস্টমারকে SMS বা মেসেজ পাঠাতে টাকা খরচ করেন কখনো?

Do you ever spend money sending SMS or messages to customers?

LISTEN FOR Comfort with paying per-message — your likely first revenue line.

05 Wrap up — referrals & a door back in

আপনার মতো আর কার সাথে এই নিয়ে কথা বলা উচিত বলে মনে করেন?

Who else like you should I talk to about this?

LISTEN FOR Warm introductions — each interview should hand you the next 2.

সামনে যদি এই নিয়ে কিছু বানাই, আপনাকে আরেকবার দেখাতে পারি? আপনার নম্বরটা রাখতে পারি?

If I build something for this later, can I show it to you again? May I keep your number?

LISTEN FOR A yes + a number = your first potential test user.

▸ Reading the room afterwards

↑ BUILD SIGNALS

- ↑ Names a real, painful taka figure lost each month
- ↑ Has an active, messy workaround they hate
- ↑ Tells an emotional story about a bad debt
- ↑ Already spends money chasing collection
- ↑ Asks when your thing will be ready

↓ PIVOT SIGNALS

- ↓ "Baki isn't really a problem for me"
- ↓ Only polite interest, no real numbers
- ↓ Tiny amounts, easily held in memory
- ↓ "Sounds nice" but never tried any solution
- ↓ Won't give a number or a referral

▸ Capture sheet — fill one per merchant

Write it down **right after** you walk away, while it's fresh. Do this for all 20–30.

Interview #_____ · Date _____

SHOP TYPE / VERTICAL

TOTAL BAKI OUTSTANDING (₹)

MONTHLY LOSS / BAD DEBT (₹)

CURRENT SYSTEM

THEIR WORDS FOR THE BIGGEST PAIN

TRIED ANY APP? WHY QUIT?

ALREADY SPENDS ON COLLECTION?

BUILD / PIVOT SIGNAL

FOLLOW-UP? PHONE NUMBER

Build the **smallest** thing a merchant can run their whole **বাকি** book on.

This spec is a fence, not a wishlist. **One core loop, five screens, offline, in Bangla.** If a feature isn't on this page, it doesn't exist until real users beg for it. Your only enemy right now is scope.

Ship by ~Week 10

Built solo

Cost: **৳0** / free tier

Target device: **cheap Android**

THE ONE JOB

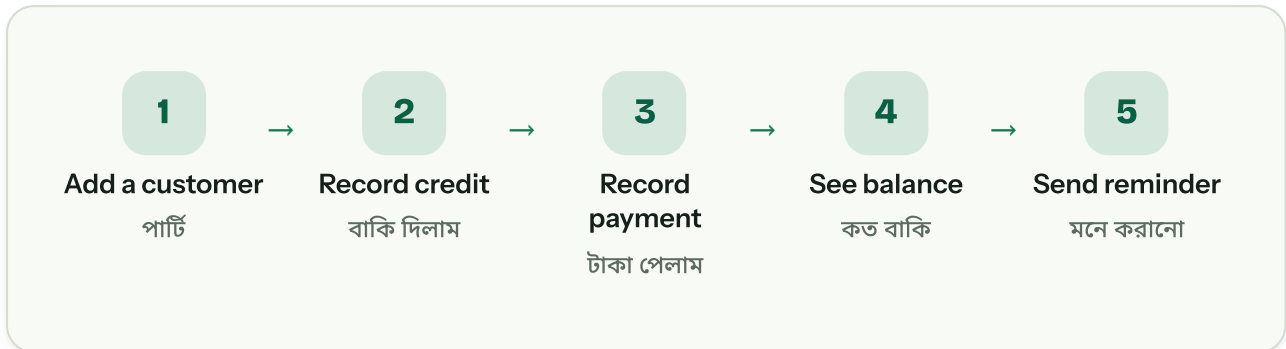
A shopkeeper can record who owes them money, log payments as they come in, always see the true total owed to them, and nudge a customer to pay — **all in Bangla, all with no internet.** Nothing else ships in v1.

POSITIONING

BakiBondhu is the collection-first ledger — the app that gets a merchant's **বাকি** *paid back*, not just written down. Where TallyKhata chases payments & lending and HishabPati sells full accounting, we go deep on one job for one vertical: recovering what's owed. Every feature below earns its place by serving that.

01 The core loop

Everything in the app serves these five steps. Build them in this order; each must feel instant.



add → owe → pay → check → nudge • then repeat, every day

02 The five screens

SCREEN 1

Home — "money out there"

- **One big number:** total owed to you across everyone
- List of customers, sorted by amount owed (biggest / oldest first)
- Each row: name + balance, tap to open
- Big "+ নতুন" button

SCREEN 2

Customer detail

- Running **balance** at top
- History: every baki & payment, newest first
- Three actions: **বাকি দিলাম · টাকা পেলাম · মনে করান**

SCREEN 3

Add transaction

- Amount (big number pad)
- Type: **credit** or **payment**
- Date (defaults to today), optional note
- One tap to save — back to detail

SCREEN 4

Add customer

- Name (required), phone (optional but pushed)
- That's it — no address, no photo, no category

SCREEN 5

Reminder preview

- Pre-written polite Bangla message, name + amount filled
- Send via **SMS or WhatsApp** (merchant taps send)
- Editable before sending

FIRST-RUN

Onboarding (under 3 min)

- No signup wall. Open → add first customer immediately
- Optional phone number for backup later, not up front
- Empty state shows one gentle "add your first বাকি" prompt

03 Data model

Two tables. That's the whole thing. Store transactions, never store a balance — always compute it.

ENTITY	FIELDS	NOTES
Customer (party)	<code>id, name, phone?, created_at</code>	Phone optional but needed for reminders
Transaction	<code>id, customer_id, type</code> (credit payment), <code>amount, note?, date,</code> <code>created_at</code>	The append-only ledger. Never edit history in v1; add a correcting entry instead

`balance(customer) = Σ credit - Σ payment · total_owed = Σ all balances`

04 The reminder — your one real differentiator

Merchant-triggered, never automatic (in v1)

This is the feature the khata apps treat as an afterthought and you treat as the point. In v1 the merchant taps "remind" and the app opens SMS/WhatsApp with a polite, pre-filled Bangla message. **No auto-sending, no scheduling, no SMS gateway yet** — that avoids cost and regulation until Phase 3, when paid reminders become your first revenue line.

PRE-FILLED MESSAGE TEMPLATE

আসসালামু আলাইকুম [নাম] ভাই। আপনার কাছে আমার দোকানে ট[পরিমাণ] বাকি আছে। সুবিধামতো একটু পরিশোধ করলে উপকৃত হতাম। ধন্যবাদ — [দোকানের নাম]।

05 Explicitly NOT in v1

THE "NOT NOW" FENCE

Every one of these is a reasonable idea. Each is also how solo MVPs die. Say no until users force your hand.

- ✗ In-app payments / bKash-Nagad wallet
- ✗ Accounting, VAT, profit reports
- ✗ Staff logins & multi-user
- ✗ Any language beyond Bangla
- ✗ Inventory, products, barcodes
- ✗ Automatic / scheduled reminders
- ✗ Web dashboard
- ✗ Editing/deleting past transactions

06 Suggested stack (all free)

APP FRAMEWORK

Flutter

One codebase, smooth on cheap Android. React Native is a fine alternative if you know it better.

LOCAL STORAGE

SQLite (offline-first)

drift/sqlite. The app must be fully usable with zero network — this is non-negotiable.

SYNC / BACKUP (LATER)

Supabase or Firebase

Free tier. v1 can even ship local-only; add cloud backup once people rely on it.

BANGLA & REMINDERS

Noto Sans Bengali + SMS/WA intent

Bundle the font; use the OS share/SMS intent — no paid gateway in v1.

07 Build sequence

Week 4

Data + logic first. SQLite tables, add customer, add transaction, compute balance. Ugly is fine — prove the numbers are right.

Week 5

Screens 1 & 2 end-to-end in Bangla. Home total + customer detail working on a real device.

Week 6

Reminder + polish. SMS/WhatsApp intent, empty states, the 3-minute first-run. Feature-complete v1.

Week 7

Test on 2–3 cheap Androids. Fix crashes & Bangla rendering. Hand to 3 friendly merchants from Phase 0.

Wk 8–10

Iterate on real use (this is Phase 2). Change only what you watch merchants struggle with — nothing else.

08 Definition of "done"

- ✓ A merchant can add a customer and record a baki in **under 15 seconds**
- ✓ The app works **fully in airplane mode**
- ✓ Home-screen total **always equals** the sum of every customer balance
- ✓ The reminder opens with the **correct name and amount** pre-filled
- ✓ The entire core loop is completable **without reading any English**
- ✓ It runs without crashing on a **₹5–8k / low-RAM Android** phone

THE ONLY METRIC THAT MATTERS IN PHASE 1

Does a merchant open the app and record a **real transaction the next day** — **without you reminding them**? If yes, you have something. If no, no feature will save it — fix the core loop before building anything else.

The app, before a line of code.

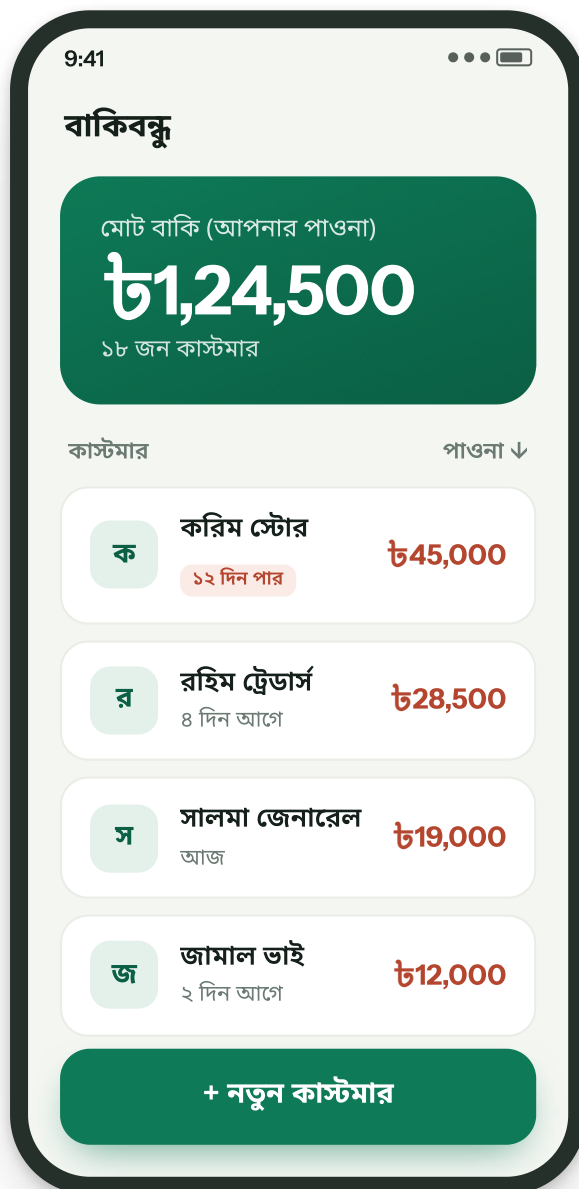
The five core screens from the MVP spec, with realistic data. **Big touch targets, Bangla-first, one clear action per screen.** This is a sketch to react to — not final visual design.

Sample data shown — নমুনা তথ্য · not a real merchant's figures

SCREEN 1

Home — "money out there"

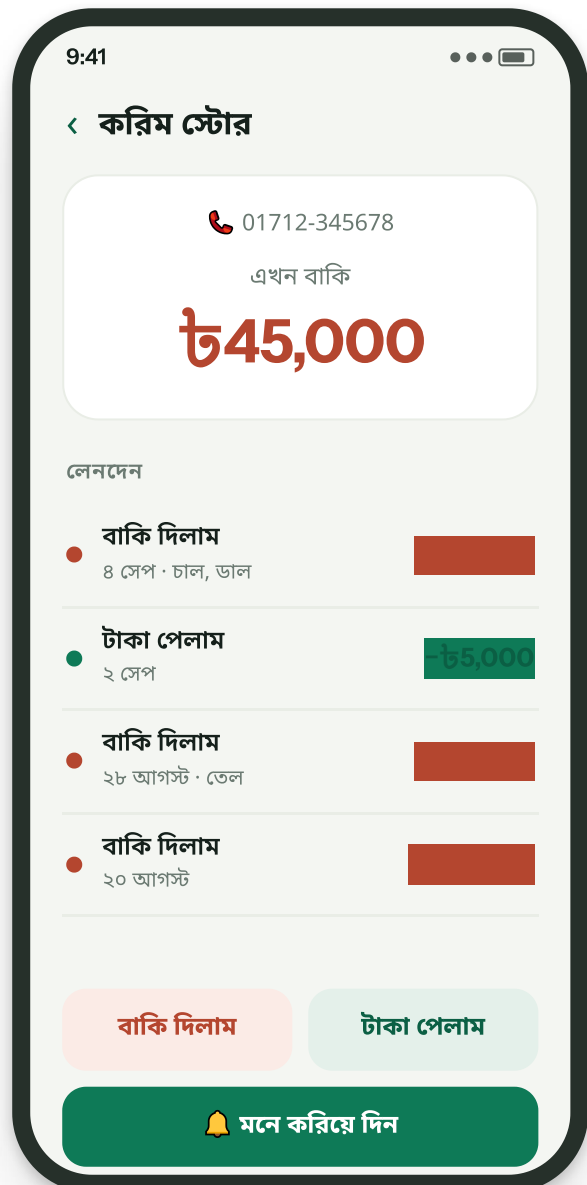
One big total, customers sorted by who owes most.



SCREEN 2

Customer detail

Balance, full history, three big actions.



SCREEN 3

Add transaction

Type toggle, big amount, number pad.

9:41

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সেভ করুন

SCREEN 4

Add customer

Name + phone. Nothing else — on purpose.

9:41

< নতুন কাস্টমার

নাম *

করিম স্টোর

মোবাইল নম্বর

01712-345678

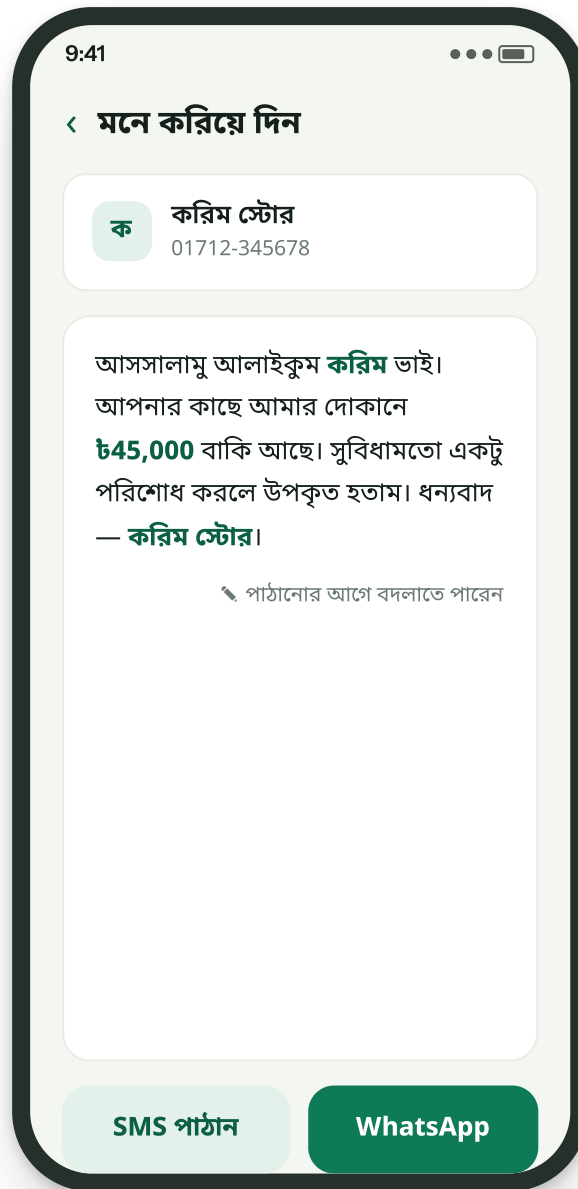
💡

নম্বর থাকলে এক চাপে বাকির কথা মনে
করিয়ে দিতে পারবেন। ঠিকানা বা ছবি লাগবে
না।

যোগ করুন

Reminder preview

Pre-filled Bangla message → SMS or WhatsApp.



What Year 1 could look like — four ways.

A driver-based model, shown as a range. Pre-revenue while building (Months 1–6), monetising from Month 7. **The real cost of Year 1 is your time, not cash** — the business's own funding gap is tiny in every case.

Interactive version → [view the live financials online](#) • [editable model: BakiBondhu_Year1_Financials.xlsx](#)

01 The range at a glance

Four scenarios differ on adoption speed, price (ARPU) and churn — from "nobody pays" to optimistic. Base is the working assumption.

METRIC	NOBODY PAYS	PESSIMISTIC	BASE	OPTIMISTIC
Year 1 revenue	₹0	₹54,825	₹196,900	₹442,375
Year 1 net profit / (loss)	(₹15,500)	₹35,488	₹171,063	₹408,296
Paying merchants @ M12	0	177	489	891
MRR @ Month 12	₹0	₹22,200	₹81,400	₹185,000
Break-even	Never	Month 7	Month 7	Month 7
Peak cash gap (business)	₹15,500	₹7,500	₹7,500	₹7,500

The true floor: if *no* merchant ever pays, you lose about ₹15,500 for the whole year — your fixed hosting, tools and one-off costs, with zero revenue. That is the entire financial downside. The real price of failure here is a year of your time, not your money.

02 Base case, month by month

No revenue while you validate & build; the deepest the business ever goes is -₹7,500 (Month 6), then it turns profitable from Month 7.

MONTH	PHASE	PAYING	REVENUE	COSTS	NET	CUMULATIVE
M1	Validate	0	₹0	₹2,000	(₹2,000)	(₹2,000)
M2	Validate	0	₹0	₹500	(₹500)	(₹2,500)
M3	Validate	0	₹0	₹500	(₹500)	(₹3,000)
M4	Build	0	₹0	₹500	(₹500)	(₹3,500)
M5	Build	0	₹0	₹500	(₹500)	(₹4,000)
M6	Build/Pilot	0	₹0	₹3,500	(₹3,500)	(₹7,500)
M7	Monetise	25	₹2,500	₹631	₹1,869	(₹5,631)
M8	Monetise	64	₹8,900	₹967	₹7,933	₹2,302
M9	Monetise	121	₹18,500	₹1,471	₹17,029	₹19,331
M10	Monetise	205	₹32,600	₹3,712	₹28,888	₹48,219
M11	Monetise	325	₹53,000	₹4,782	₹48,218	₹96,437
M12	Monetise	489	₹81,400	₹6,774	₹74,626	₹171,063

03 Base-case assumptions

ARPU ₹200/mo

Churn 5%/mo

Reminders 30/merchant/mo

SMS cost ₹0.35

Hosting free → ₹2k/mo late

Founder salary ₹0 (sweat equity)

Freelance runway ~₹40k → ₹20k/mo

04 Read the model honestly

THESE ARE ASSUMPTIONS, NOT FORECASTS

- **The good news is real:** the business's cash-at-risk is ~₹7,500 in every scenario — because the risk sits in the pre-revenue build months, which don't change. Low money risk, high time risk.
- **The floor is now on the table:** the "Nobody pays" column is the honest worst case — ₹0 revenue, a ~₹15,500 loss. Small in money, painful in time. Also try pushing churn to 15–20% on the paying scenarios to see how fast good numbers unravel.
- **Everything hinges on one unproven number:** that merchants will pay ₹150–250/month at all. Phase 0's willingness-to-pay questions test exactly this.
- **Churn is the silent killer,** not slow growth. At 5%/mo you keep a merchant ~20 months; at 15% barely 7. Retention is the whole business.

Help me build the app that gets Bangladesh's shopkeepers **paid back**.

Millions of merchants sell on **বাকি** and quietly lose money they're owed. **We fix that** — starting in Bangladesh, then everywhere the paper ledger still rules.

~8M

micro & small businesses in Bangladesh

Paper

how most still track who owes them

1M+

already use a digital ledger — behaviour is proven

৳0

raised — pure upside, sweat equity

THE PROBLEM

Shopkeepers are great at selling on credit — and terrible at **collecting it**.

Every grocery, pharmacy, and wholesaler sells on **বাকি**. They track it in a notebook, forget who owes what, feel awkward chasing it, and lose real money every month. The recording isn't the pain — **getting the money back is**.

OUR INSIGHT

**Everyone built the ledger.
Nobody owns the collection.**

The big players — TallyKhata, HishabPati — help merchants *record* dues, but collection is a buried feature. TallyKhata's real game is payments & lending; HishabPati sells full accounting. **We do one job better than anyone: recovering what's owed** — polite one-tap reminders, aging, and workflow built deep for one trade. Simple, free to start, Bangla-first.

The rails are finally in place.

Cheap Android phones are everywhere, and bKash/Nagad made digital money normal. The behaviour shift already happened — **1M+ merchants use a digital ledger today**. And the same "credit ledger for informal merchants" idea built a giant in India (Khatabook). The demand is proven; the collection-first angle is wide open.

THE EVIDENCE • FILL IN AFTER YOUR INTERVIEWS

What merchants told me.

This is the most persuasive thing on the page — real words and real numbers from your Phase 0 interviews and Merchant Tracker. Replace the placeholders below, then delete this note.

"[Paste a real quote about how much baki is stuck, or a bad debt that hurt.]"

– [shop type, area]

"[A quote about the pain of reminding people, or why they quit another app.]"

– [shop type, area]

₹__

avg baki stuck per merchant

₹__

avg lost each month

₹/₹

would pay for it

__

merchants interviewed

↳ these numbers come straight from your Merchant Tracker Summary tab

THE PLAN

PHASE 0

Validate

20–30 merchant interviews; pick the vertical

PHASE 1

MVP

5 screens, offline, Bangla; the collection loop

PHASE 2

50 users

daily use & less stuck money = product-market fit

PHASE 3

Monetise

paid reminders & pro tools → then new markets

Small fees, huge numbers.

A merchant who recovers even a few thousand taka a month will happily pay a small fee.

1,000 paying merchants × ₹200/mo ≈ ₹2,00,000/mo — enough to go full-time and prove the model. Then the same product travels: India, Pakistan, Nigeria, Indonesia. Software scales to new markets at near-zero cost.

THE TEAM

What I bring

- ✓ Technical founder — I can build the product myself
- ✓ The full strategy, MVP spec & competitor work already done
- ✓ Committed for the long haul; funding my own runway via freelancing
- ✓ Deep belief in the local-impact mission

What I need in you

- You own **merchants** — sales, distribution, on-the-ground trust
- Comfortable in the bazaar, not just behind a screen
- Ready to share the risk: equity, not salary, at the start
- Relentless about talking to users and closing deals

WHERE IT STANDS — HONESTLY

Pre-launch, plan-ready, homework done.

- ✓ Strategy, competitor analysis, MVP spec, screen mockups & financial model — **all done.**
- No users, no revenue, no code yet. **The next step is merchant interviews.**
- This is a ground-floor seat. You'd help shape the product and the company from day one.

Want to build it with me?

If getting a country's shopkeepers paid back sounds like a mission worth your time — let's talk.

Rafiq rafiq.ru.cse@gmail.com

↳ update this contact line before you share the pitch